

it and now you want to check whether the same file name exists or not. You can use a simple function, `file_exists()`. It takes the name (of a file or a directory) with the relative path as an argument. If the file exists, it returns true. If it returns 'false' then it indicates that the file did not exist.

Sometimes, as per our requirements, we need to check the existence of a directory. You can do this by using `is_dir()` function. This function also requires a name with a relative path as an argument and also returns a Boolean value. Look at the example:

```
if ( is_dir( "ABC" ) )  
    print "ABC is a directory";
```

The above program will print "ABC is a directory" if a directory ABC exists in the working folder/directory.

Once you are sure of the existence of the file, you can manipulate it in multiple ways. Now, you can easily read, write on or execute this file. PHP supports all these mechanisms. Often on UNIX Systems, you can see a particular file, but cannot read its contents. The '`is_readable()`' function briefs whether a particular file is readable or not. This function accepts the file path in a string and returns a Boolean value. Look at the example:

```
<?php  
Is_readable("XYZ.txt");  
print "XYZ.txt is readable";  
?>
```

The above program will print "XYZ.txt is readable" if the file XYZ.txt is found readable.

To confirm whether a file is writable or not, there is a separate function named `is_writable()`. This function also requires a file path. It returns a Boolean value: true if the file is writable and false otherwise. Similarly, there is another function `is_executable()` that tells whether a file is executable or not. To verify if a file XYZ.txt is executable, you can use, '`is_executable("XYZ.txt")`'. This function returns true if the file is executable and false otherwise.